After this, I would have a handwritten letter read out by one of the young men sitting in the gathering. This letter, from the person of a dead terrorist, was from someone undergoing training in a camp located in 'Ilaqa Gair', the no-man's-land between Pakistan and Afghanistan, to his family back home. Unfortunately, a bullet had stopped its courier from reaching his destination. Not only had the projectile pierced through the chest of the terrorist, it also went through this letter found in his breast pocket. It read something like this:

> … *Mai yahaan par theek hoon. Allah ke raham se aap sabh theek honge. Yahaan ke halaat bahut kharab hai. Yeh log hamko sabz baag dikhaate rahe. Asli baat kuch aur hai. Hamse barha bewaqoof koi nahin ho sakta. Ham inki baton men aa gaye. Aur kisi ko yahaan mat aane dena*…. (I am okay here. With the grace of Allah, I hope you all are fine. The conditions here are terrible. These people have been showing us gardens which appear greener than they actually are. The reality is something else. There is no one who is a bigger fool than us. We got taken in by their words. Don't let anyone else come here….)

Continuing my interaction, I would go on:

> *Dear Kashmiri brothers, get a hold of your destiny. The outsiders have come with their own designs. They have no love lost for you and your future generations, who are being made to pay the price for this violence and strife. There is much talk in the valley of 'azaadi' or freedom. Jammu and Kashmir is much more than the valley. Therefore, it would be wrong to assume that the people from the valley represent all Kashmiris. We have to bear in mind that there are diverse views on this issue. We cannot ignore the people of other areas and regions of J&K such as Jammu, Udhampur, Doda, Kishtwar, Poonch, Kargil and Ladakh. This state also comprises swathes of territory in Gilgit, Skardu, Hunza, and other parts of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir such as Muzzafarabad and Mirpur (Map 11.1 and Panorama 11.1). What about them?*
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> *The valley, with a small area about 55 kilometres wide and 108 kilometres long, would be unviable as an independent entity. India is an emerging power and a subcontinent with huge natural resources and a large population. Perhaps a way could be found by a dialogue on the basis of more autonomy. Kashmir has always been a part of Hindustan, encircled by the Hindu Kush and Karakoram ranges to its north and northwest, and the*